

Guideline for constitution and functioning of Sexual Harassment Committee in SSD Hostels

This Department is committed to protect the interest of its boarder both boys and girls along with their safety and security. Accordingly, instructions have been issued from time to time in this regard. Two detailed instructions issued in this regard are Safety Security Guidelines issued vide Department Letter No 33963 dated 24.12.2014 and SOP on teenage pregnancy issued vide Department letter NO 3032 dated 9.02.2021.

A. Constitution

Each school shall constitute a Sexual Harassment Committee separately for girls boarder & boys boarder staying in the hostels attached to the said school as detailed below: -

I. Sexual Harassment Committee for Girls boarders

The committee shall be constituted under the chairmanship of the senior most Lady teacher with the following other members:

- Asst Lady Superintendent
- Matron
- ANM wherever available
- Two senior boarder girls' students.

II. Sexual harassment Committee for Boys boarders

The committee shall be constituted under the chairmanship of Headmaster/Head Sevak with the following other members.

- Asst. superintendent
- ANM wherever available
- Two senior boarder boy students

B. Installation of POC SO Box & functions of the Committee

- There shall be a **POC SO Box** in each hostel and the same shall be placed in a prominent place. The box must be wall mounted and shall be within the access of all the boarder students. Any complaint relating to sexual harassment shall be put in the box in writing.
- The POC SO box shall have a double lock arrangement.
- One key shall be with the Asst. Superintendent and another with one of the boarder students who is a Committee member.
- The POC SO Box shall be **opened every day at 4.00 pm** in presence of at least three Committee members.
- The Committee shall meet once in a week to review the sexual harassment complaint received; action taken thereof & also take regular feedback from the students & staffs. Besides, the Committee shall also meet on emergency whenever required particularly if any such incidence brought to the notice of the Committee members.

- Two registers shall be maintained i) one for recording the complaints received and ii) for recording the proceedings of the sexual harassment committee.
- The format for recording complaints in POC SO register is given below.

Sl. No.	Date of opening of POC SO Box	Name of the Committee Members present during opening	Whether any complaint has been found (Yes/No)	If yes, brief subject of the complaint	Response / ATR	Status (Closed / Open)	Signature of the senior Member of the committee	Counter Signature of the HM

If any incidence of sexual abuse/harassment/teenage pregnancy comes to the notice of any staff, the same shall immediately be reported to HM & Chairman of the sexual harassment Committee who will further inform DWO for immediate action. DWO concerned shall immediately take appropriate action and shall keep the higher authorities and Department informed on the matter.

C. Review & Follow Up

- The progress & activities undertaken by the Committee shall be reviewed weekly by the concerned HM.
- The monitoring officials like WEO, ADWO, DWO etc. will check the functioning of Sexual Harassment Committee and also shall verify the register prescribed during their routine monitoring visits.



Commissioner-cum- Secretary to Govt.